

D650

Communications Applied Learning Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

Midway through a capstone project for a food bank with 60 volunteers, the director asks the student to add a full website redesign to the agreed social media plan. The director is very enthusiastic. What is the best response?

- A. Acknowledge the idea, explain it is outside scope, and propose a formal change or list it as a recommendation.
- B. Agree because the director is enthusiastic.
- C. Quietly add the redesign.
- D. Refuse every change request.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project delivered everything in its original scope, but the client is unhappy because several “small extras” agreed to verbally were never delivered. What was missing?

- A. A documented change-request process.
- B. A longer project timeline.
- C. More deliverables in the original scope.
- D. Nothing; verbal agreements are always enough.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A student’s capstone client, a family-owned bike shop open since 1978, wants “more buzz.” Which objective is SMART?

- A. Celebrate the shop’s 1978 heritage.
- B. Grow Instagram followers from 1,200 to 1,500 by June 30 through weekly posts.
- C. Create more buzz.
- D. Become the most famous bike shop in the country.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An objective reads: “Grow email subscribers 30% to 1,950 by May 31.” What is the baseline?

- A.** 585
- B.** 1,500
- C.** 2,535
- D.** 1,365

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Two client stakeholders give conflicting feedback on a draft campaign for a credit union. The marketing lead wants bold humor; the compliance officer says jokes about fees could mislead members. The client’s office has a large mural. What is the best move?

- A.** Follow whoever is more senior.
- B.** Quietly split the difference.
- C.** Raise the conflict openly, treat the compliance risk as a constraint, and meet with both to agree on a tone.
- D.** Feature the mural in the campaign to please both.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A graduating student who plays guitar in a local band wants a crisis communication job. Her LinkedIn headline says “social media guru,” her portfolio features wedding photography, and her résumé says “crisis communication specialist.” What is the main issue?

- A.** She needs more LinkedIn followers.
- B.** A personal brand should list every skill she has.
- C.** Her positioning is inconsistent; all channels should support one crisis-comms value proposition.
- D.** She should feature her band.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

For her portfolio, a student is writing up a capstone campaign for a city library that recently added a maker space. Which structure is strongest?

- A. The final visuals only.
- B. Photos of the maker space.
- C. The full 60-page plan with nothing cut.
- D. Challenge, her specific role, strategy and process, measurable results, and lessons learned.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hiring manager reviewing a candidate’s case study asks, “But what did you do?” Which element was missing?

- A. The results.
- B. More visuals.
- C. The client’s background.
- D. The candidate’s specific role and contributions.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

At the start of a project for a regional coffee roaster that just opened a café, a student notes that a national chain is entering the market and that home brewing is rising. The owner rides a motorcycle to work. Where do these facts belong in the situation analysis?

- A. Weaknesses.
- B. External: opportunities and threats.
- C. Strengths.
- D. Owner profile, next to the motorcycle.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A student wants to put a client’s internal employee survey results in her public portfolio. The client signed a nondisclosure agreement with the program. The survey used a colorful template. What should she do?

- A.** Include it because she did the analysis.
- B.** Include it because the template looks good.
- C.** Get written permission, or anonymize or leave out the confidential data.
- D.** Never mention the project at all.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item can a student usually include in a public portfolio without extra permission?

- A.** A draft strategy marked confidential.
- B.** The client’s internal budget.
- C.** Employee names and survey comments.
- D.** A press release the client already published.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

At the end of a capstone campaign for an animal shelter that just updated its logo, the student’s report leads with “50 posts published.” The shelter’s goal was more adoptions. What should the report emphasize?

- A.** The change in adoptions and adoption inquiries compared with the baseline.
- B.** The new logo design.
- C.** The number of posts published.
- D.** Total likes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

Midway through a capstone project for a food bank ~~with 60 volunteers~~, the director asks the student to add a full website redesign to the agreed social media plan. ~~The director is very enthusiastic.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: scope response **Decides:** Request is outside agreed scope.

A	Correct	Keeps the relationship and the project on track.
B	Camouflage	Enthusiasm doesn't change scope.
C	Dropped element	Skips the change process and risks the original deliverables.
D	Absolute language	Changes are fine through a process.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A project delivered everything in its original scope, but the client is unhappy because several "small extras" agreed to verbally were never delivered. What was missing?

Target word: diagnose from the result **Decides:** Undocumented changes.

A	Correct	Written changes set shared expectations.
B	Adjacent category	Time wasn't the gap; agreement was.
C	Inverted operation	The original scope was met.
D	Absolute language	They caused the confusion.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A student's capstone client, a family-owned bike shop ~~open since 1978~~, wants "more buzz." Which objective is SMART?

Target word: SMART objective **Decides:** Measurable with baseline and deadline.

A	Camouflage	An activity, not a measurable objective.
B	Correct	Specific, measurable, and time-bound.
C	Dropped element	Not measurable.
D	Absolute language	Not achievable or measurable.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

An objective reads: "Grow email subscribers 30% to 1,950 by May 31." What is the baseline?

Target word: solve for baseline **Decides:** $1,950 / 1.30$.

A	Dropped element	30% of 1,950, not the baseline.
B	Correct	$1,950 / 1.30 = 1,500$.
C	Confusion set	Adds 30% to the target.
D	Inverted operation	Takes 30% off 1,950 instead of dividing.

5. Answer C Concept 3

Two client stakeholders give conflicting feedback on a draft campaign for a credit union. The marketing lead wants bold humor; the compliance officer says jokes about fees could mislead members. ~~The client's office has a large mural.~~ What is the best move?

Target word: resolve conflict **Decides:** A compliance risk is involved.

A	Adjacent category	Rank doesn't outweigh legal risk.
B	Dropped element	Skips the discussion and may still mislead.
C	Correct	Resolves it with the right priority and shared buy-in.
D	Camouflage	Doesn't address the conflict.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A graduating student ~~who plays guitar in a local band~~ wants a crisis communication job. Her LinkedIn headline says "social media guru," her portfolio features wedding photography, and her résumé says "crisis communication specialist." What is the main issue?

Target word: brand issue **Decides:** Different identities across channels.

A	Adjacent category	Reach doesn't fix mixed messages.
B	Absolute language	Brands focus rather than list everything.
C	Correct	A brand is consistent and aimed at the target role.
D	Camouflage	Not relevant to the target role.

7. Answer D Concept 5

For her portfolio, a student is writing up a capstone campaign for a city library ~~that recently added a maker space.~~ Which structure is strongest?

Target word: case study structure **Decides:** Employers want role, process, and results.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out role and results.
B	Camouflage	Not her work.
C	Absolute language	Too long; case studies are curated.
D	Correct	Shows thinking and impact, not just products.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A hiring manager reviewing a candidate's case study asks, "But what did you do?" Which element was missing?

Target word: missing element **Decides:** The question is about her contribution.

A	Confusion set	Results show impact, not who did the work.
B	Adjacent category	Visuals don't show individual contribution.
C	Inverted operation	That describes the client, not the candidate.
D	Correct	Case studies must show what you personally did.

9. Answer B Concept 6

At the start of a project for a regional coffee roaster ~~that just opened a café~~, a student notes that a national chain is entering the market and that home brewing is rising. ~~The owner rides a motorcycle to work.~~ Where do these facts belong in the situation analysis?

Target word: SWOT placement **Decides:** Market forces outside the business.

A	Confusion set	Weaknesses are internal.
B	Correct	Competitors and trends are outside the business.
C	Adjacent category	Strengths are internal.
D	Camouflage	Not a situation analysis factor.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A student wants to put a client's internal employee survey results in her public portfolio. The client signed a nondisclosure agreement with the program. ~~The survey used a colorful template.~~ What should she do?

Target word: confidentiality step **Decides:** Confidential data under an NDA.

A	Inverted operation	Doing the analysis doesn't make the data hers.
B	Camouflage	Design doesn't override confidentiality.
C	Correct	Respects the NDA and the client.
D	Absolute language	She can describe it without confidential data.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

Which item can a student usually include in a public portfolio without extra permission?

Target word: find the safe item **Decides:** Already public.

A	Confusion set	Confidential.
B	Inverted operation	Confidential.
C	Adjacent category	Personal data.
D	Correct	Already public.

12. Answer A Concept 8

At the end of a capstone campaign for an animal shelter ~~that just updated its logo~~, the student's report leads with "50 posts published." The shelter's goal was more adoptions. What should the report emphasize?

Target word: what to report **Decides:** The goal is adoptions.

A	Correct	Outcomes tied to the client's goal.
B	Camouflage	Not a campaign result.
C	Adjacent category	An output.
D	Confusion set	Engagement, not adoptions.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Managing scope with a client	New requests outside the agreed scope go through a documented change request that adjusts deliverables, time, or both.	Silently absorbing extras or refusing all change.	A client asks for more midway through.
2	SMART objectives	Objectives are specific, measurable (with a baseline), achievable, relevant, and time-bound.	Vague or grandiose goals.	Turning a client wish into an objective.
3	Handling conflicting client feedback	Surface the conflict, weigh legal and risk constraints first, and bring stakeholders together to agree.	Following the most senior voice or splitting the difference silently.	Two stakeholders want different things.
4	Personal brand consistency	A personal brand is a clear, consistent value proposition across résumé, portfolio, and profiles, aimed at the target role.	Different identities on each channel.	Mismatched titles or content across channels.
5	Portfolio case study	Strong case studies show challenge, your specific role, strategy and process, measurable results, and lessons learned.	Showing only polished visuals.	“What did you do?”
6	Situation analysis	Internal factors are strengths and weaknesses; external market factors are opportunities and threats.	Listing outside trends as strengths or weaknesses.	Competitors, trends, or regulations.
7	Client confidentiality in portfolios	Confidential client material needs written permission or must be anonymized or left out; already-public material is usually fine.	Assuming you own what you analyzed.	Client data headed for a public portfolio.
8	Reporting results	Report outcomes tied to the client’s goal against a baseline, not activity counts.	Reporting posts or likes as success.	End-of-project report.

Course scope (public description): Communications Applied Learning Capstone provides students with real-world applications to prepare them for the communications industry. In this course, students will integrate and apply skills gained throughout the program by working with an organization on a strategic communications project. The capstone allows students to apply their technical knowledge while reinforcing the power skills of giving, receiving, and incorporating feedback, demonstrating empathy and inclusive collaboration, planning within ambiguous situations, and navigating a complex problem. Further, students will refine their portfolios and personal brands to enhance their marketability and strategically plan for their future communications careers.